gidly and sloppily. It would be even worse than doing a Navy Yard specification, and I didn't know how I could bear it.

Well then, instead of writing a story about a compound that dissolved before it hit the water, why not write a mock dissertation about it? Why not deliberately write turgidly and sloppily and in this way draw the fangs of the monster?

I suggested such a thing to Campbell on that May 26, and he laughed and said, "Go try it."

On that same May 26 something else happened. Thrilling Wonder, despite its rejection of "The Hunted," still insisted it wanted Astounding-type stories from me, so before I visited Campbell that day, I had dropped in to see the editor of Thrilling Wonder. The editor was, at this time, Sam Merwin, Jr. (his father and namesake had been a well-known author and editor).

It was the first time we had met. Sam, a plump and friendly man, told me that not only did he want a story from me but also he wanted a 40,000-word lead novel for Startling Stories y the sister magazine of Thrilling Wonder. Startling featured such a lead novel in every issue, and good ones were hard to come by. I was enamored with the notion myself, since 40,000 words at $.02 a word came to $800, so I agreed to try.

I got to work on the story for Merwin on June 2. I called it "Grow Old with Me." This was supposed to be a quotation from Robert Browning's "Rabbi ben Ezra" and should have been "Grow Old Along with Me," but I remembered the line incorrectly and didn't bother checking.

It dealt with an old tailor who managed to get transferred into a future in which old people underwent euthanasia unless they could prove themselves useful to society. The problem was to work out a way in which an old tailor from the past could prove useful enough to a society of the future to be kept alive. I was so excited at the thought of $800 that I did ten pages that first day and five the day after.

Then, on June 5, unable to resist the other project, I began writing my mock dissertation, which I called, in true dissertation form, "The Endochronic Properties of Resublimated Thiotimoline." (I had intended a still longer title but it would have to fit into the Astounding Table of Contents and I would have to be realistic about it.) I finished it on June 8, complete with tables, graphs, and with references to nonexistent journals, and then took it in to Campbell.